



The Freelance Tax Checklist

A comprehensive guide to maximizing your deductions under HMRC and IRS guidelines. Keep this handy when logging your expenses to ensure you never miss a deductible item.

1. Office & Working From Home 🏠

Whether you have a dedicated external office or work from a home office, many of these costs are tax-deductible.

- ☐ **Rent or Lease:** Proportion of rent for your dedicated workspace.
- ☐ **Utilities:** Electricity, heating, and water (pro-rated for home offices).
- ☐ **Internet & Phone:** Business percentage of your monthly broadband and mobile phone bills.
- ☐ **Office Supplies:** Stationery, printer ink, postage, and small desk accessories.
- ☐ **Repairs & Maintenance:** Upkeep of your business equipment or office space.

2. Travel & Mileage 🚗

Keep precise logs of your travel! Only travel wholly and exclusively for your business qualifies.

- ☐ **Business Mileage:** Miles driven for client meetings or business errands (using standard IRS/HMRC mileage rates).
- ☐ **Public Transport:** Train, bus, and subway fares for business travel.
- ☐ **Flights & Accommodation:** Airfare and hotel stays for conferences, client visits, or business trips.
- ☐ **Parking & Tolls:** Parking fees and highway tolls incurred during business travel.
- ☐ **Subsistence / Meals:** Meals purchased while travelling away from your normal place of work (subject to local limits).

3. Subscriptions & Professional Fees 📁

The tools and expertise you need to run your freelance business.

- ☐ **Software Subscriptions:** Adobe Creative Cloud, Microsoft 365, Webflow, Figma, CRM tools, etc.
- ☐ **Web Hosting & Domains:** Costs for maintaining your portfolio or business website.
- ☐ **Professional Memberships:** Dues for industry associations and professional bodies.
- ☐ **Legal & Financial Fees:** Costs for an accountant, tax advisor, or legal counsel.
- ☐ **Insurance:** Professional indemnity, public liability, or business equipment insurance.
- ☐ **Marketing & Advertising:** Facebook Ads, Google Ads, SEO tools, and business cards.

4. Asset Depreciation (Capital Allowances) 🖨️

Large purchases that hold value over time are typically depreciated over several years.

- ☐ **Computer Equipment:** Laptops, desktop computers, monitors, and tablets.
- ☐ **Office Furniture:** Desks, ergonomic chairs, filing cabinets.
- ☐ **Specialized Gear:** Cameras, microphones, lighting equipment (if essential for your business).

- ☐ **Vehicles:** A portion of the cost of a vehicle used for your business.

Disclaimer: *Tax laws change frequently and vary by jurisdiction. This checklist is a general guide and does not replace professional tax advice. Always consult with a qualified tax professional to ensure compliance with the latest IRS or HMRC regulations.*